

TIMELINE

- **March 6, 1831** Born in Albany, New York, the third of six children, to Irish immigrants John and Mary Sheridan; grows up in Somerset, Ohio.
- **June 1853** Graduates from West Point, 34th in a class of 52, and is commissioned a second lieutenant in the infantry.
- **March-May 1861** With the advent of war, is promoted to first lieutenant, then captain. Holds various staff positions, including quartermaster general of the Army of Southwest Missouri.
- **May 27, 1862** Arrested for insubordination—after refusing to “steal” horses for the army. Appointed colonel of the 2nd Michigan Cavalry.
- **July 1, 1862** After the Battle of Booneville, is promoted to brigadier general.
- **December 31, 1862** Promoted to major general after the Battle of Stones River.
- **November 25, 1863** Impresses Grant with his assault on Missionary Ridge.
- **April 5, 1864** Takes command of the Army of the Potomac’s cavalry corps.
- **May 9-23, 1864** Leads a massive cavalry raid, battling Jeb Stuart’s troopers at Yellow Tavern, where Stuart is fatally wounded.
- **June 12, 1864** On a raid to disrupt Confederate supply lines in western Virginia, is defeated by General Wade Hampton at Trevilian Station.
- **August 7, 1864** Takes command of the Army of Shenandoah, charged by Grant with destroying the Valley’s usefulness as a Confederate granary.
- **October 19, 1864** Gallops from Winchester, Virginia, to Cedar Creek, to rally his troops—an episode known as “Sheridan’s Ride.”
- **April 9, 1865** Cuts off Lee’s escape at Appomattox, forcing the Confederate surrender.
- **March 1867** Appointed governor of the Fifth Military District, covering Louisiana and Texas, but is soon removed by President Andrew Johnson after a clash over Reconstruction policy.
- **August 1867** Appointed chief of the Military Department of Missouri, responsible for operations against the Lakota and Cheyenne.
- **March 4, 1869** Promoted to lieutenant general on Grant’s accession to the presidency.
- **June 3, 1875** Marries Irene Rucker, 22 years his junior. They have four children.
- **November 1, 1883** Succeeds Sherman as general of the Army.